

Chapter 11

Sharing and Reviewing Documents

Introduction

This chapter covers methods for editing shared documents: sharing (collaboration), recording changes, adding comments, reviewing changes, merging and comparing documents, and saving and using document versions. Basic editing techniques are discussed in Chapter 2 (Entering, Editing, and Formatting Data).

Sharing Documents (Collaboration)

In OpenOffice Writer, Impress, and Draw, only one user at a time can open any document for editing. In Calc, many users can simultaneously open the same spreadsheet for writing.

Each user who wants to collaborate should enter a name on the **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > User Data** page.

Some menu commands are unavailable (grayed out) when change tracking or document sharing is activated.

Setting up a Spreadsheet for Sharing

You can set up a spreadsheet for sharing with others at any time. With the spreadsheet document open, choose **Tools > Share Document** to activate the collaboration features for this document. A dialog opens where you can enable or disable sharing, as shown below.

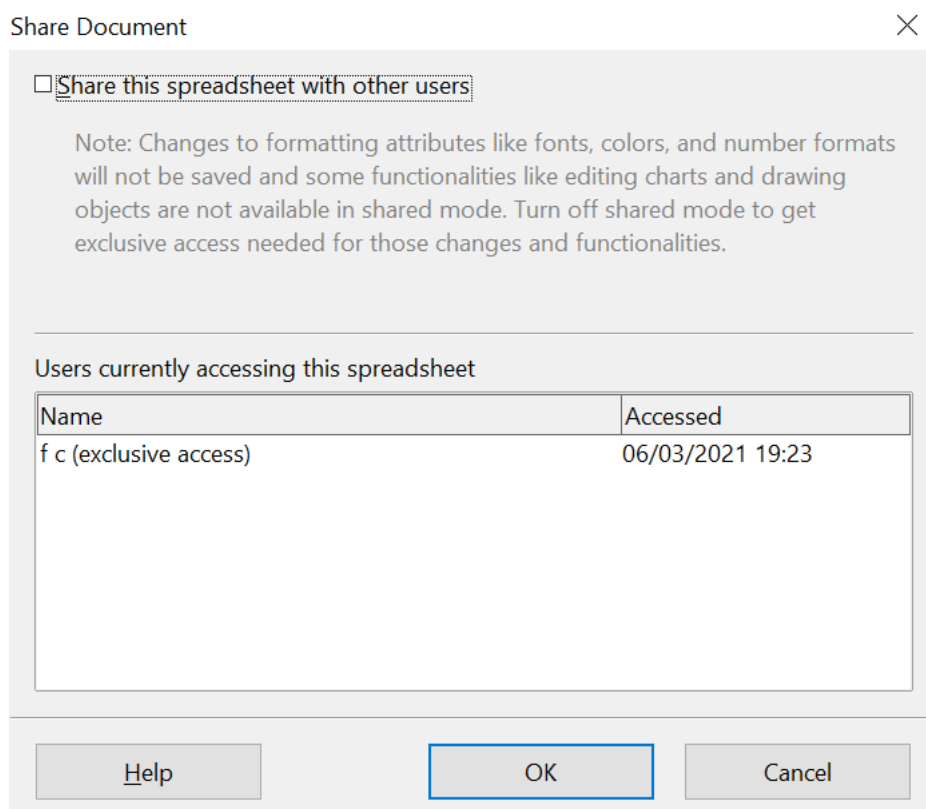


Figure 1: Choosing to share a spreadsheet

To enable sharing, select the box at the top of the dialog, then click **OK**. A message will state you must save the document to activate shared mode. Click **Yes** to continue. The word **(shared)** will appear on the title bar after the document's title.

The **Tools > Share Document** command can switch the mode for a document from unshared to shared. However, if you want to use a shared document in unshared mode, you need to save the shared document using another file name or path. This creates a copy of the spreadsheet that is not shared.

Opening a Shared Spreadsheet

When you open a spreadsheet document in shared mode, a message appears stating that the document is in shared mode and that some features are unavailable. After clicking **OK**, the document opens in shared mode.

The following features are known to be disabled in a shared spreadsheet document:

Menu	Item	Sub Item
Edit	Changes, except for Merge Document	
Edit	Compare Document	
Edit	Sheet	Move/Copy & Delete
Insert	Cells Shift Cells Down & Shift Cells Right	
Insert	Sheet from file	
Insert	Names	
Insert	Comment	
Insert	Picture	From File
Insert	Movie and Sound	
Insert	Object	
Insert	Chart	
Insert	Floating Frame	
Format	Sheet	Rename, Tab Color
Format	Merge Cells	
Format	Print Ranges	
Format	Page (but format in Print Preview is enabled)	
Tools	Protect Document	
Data	Define Range	
Data	Sort	
Data	Subtotals	
Data	Validity	
Data	Multiple Operations	
Data	Consolidate	
Data	Group and Outline (all)	

Data	Pivot Table (all)	
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Saving a Shared Spreadsheet

When you save a shared spreadsheet, one of several scenarios may occur:

- If the document has not been modified and saved by another user since you opened it, it is saved.
- If the document has been modified and saved by another user since you opened it, one of the following events will occur:
 - If the changes do not conflict, the document is saved, the message below appears, and any cells modified by the other user are shown with a red border.

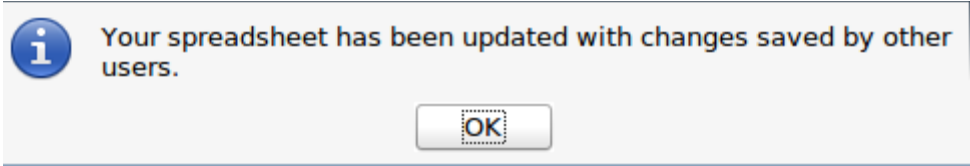


Figure 2: Update message after saving

- If the changes conflict, the Resolve Conflicts dialog is shown (see Figure 3). For each conflict, you must decide which version to keep, yours or the other author's. When all conflicts are resolved, the document is saved. While you are resolving the conflicts, no other user can save the shared document.

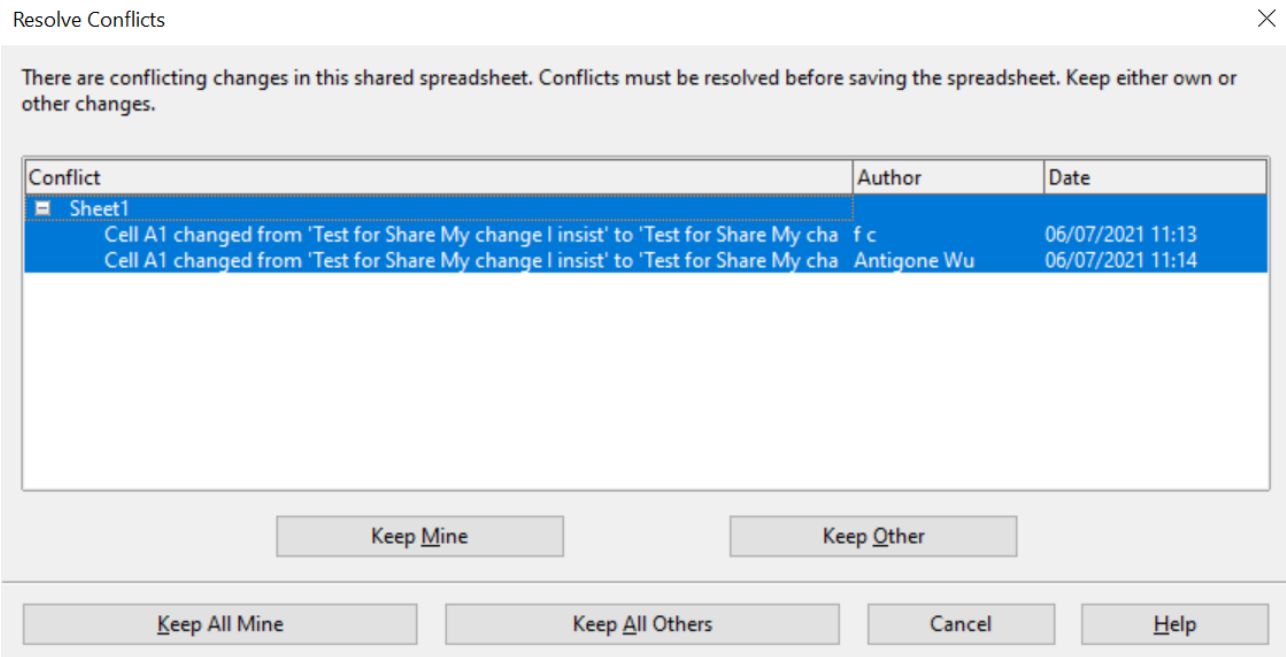


Figure 3: Resolve Conflicts dialog

- If another user tries to save the shared document and resolve conflicts, they receive a message that the shared spreadsheet file is locked due to a merge-in in progress. They can cancel the Save command and retry saving later.

When you successfully save a shared spreadsheet, the document shows the latest version of all changes saved by every user.

Recording Changes

You can use several methods to record and view changes you or others make to a document.

- You can use change marks to show added material, deleted material, and changes to formatting. Later, you or another person can review the document and accept or reject each change.
- If you are not using file sharing, you can make changes to a copy of the document (stored in a different folder, under a different name, or both), then use Calc to compare the files and show the changes. See page 13.
- You can save versions that are stored as part of the original file. See page 14.

Reviewers can leave comments in the document, either attached to specific changes or standalone.

Preparing a Document for Review (Optional)

When you send a document to someone else to review or edit, you may want to protect it first so that the editor or reviewer does not have to remember to turn on revision marks. After you have protected the document, any user must enter the correct password to turn off protection and accept or reject changes.

- 1) Open the document and make sure that the **Edit > Changes > Record** menu item has a checkmark next to it, indicating that change recording is active.
- 2) (Optional) Click **Edit > Changes > Protect Records**. On the Protect Records dialog, type a password (twice) and click **OK**.

Note

It is not necessary to password-protect the document to prepare it for review.

Identifying Copies of Spreadsheets

When not using the document sharing feature, it is important to keep track of all copies of the document. This can be done either with the file name or the file title. If you have not provided a file title in the spreadsheet's properties, the spreadsheet's file name is displayed in the title bar. To set the title of the spreadsheet, select **File > Properties > Description**.

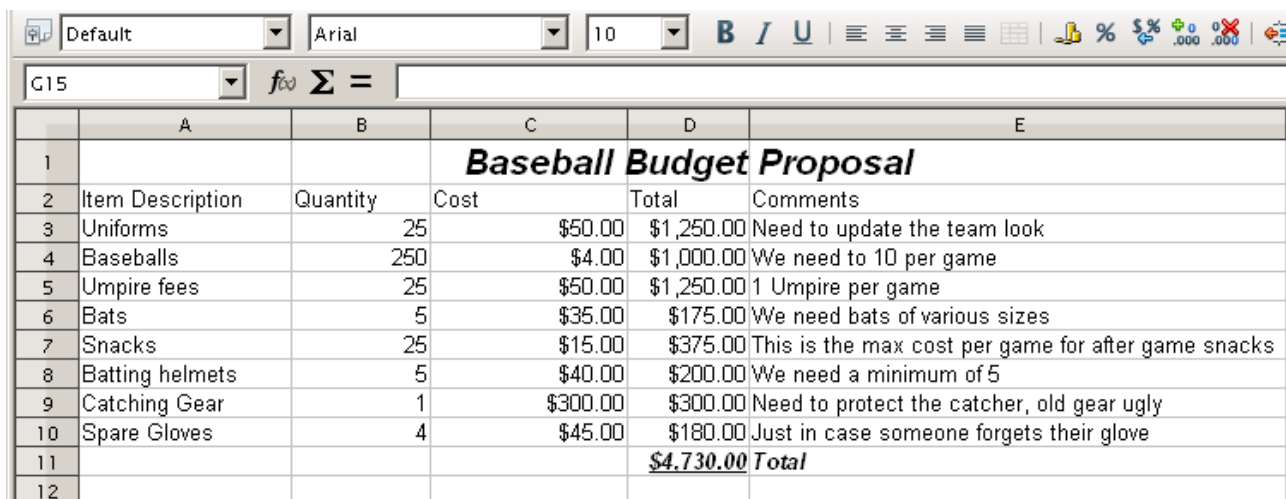
Recording Changes (Tutorial)

For this chapter, we will work with a budget proposal for a baseball team.

You are the sponsor of a youth baseball team. The coach has submitted a budget to you for the season and you need to edit the costs and return it to her.

You are concerned that if you make the changes, the coach won't see the changes you made. You decide to use Calc with the record changes feature turned on so the coach can easily see your changes

Figure 4 shows the budget spreadsheet your coach submitted.



	A	B	C	D	E
1			Baseball Budget Proposal		
2	Item Description	Quantity	Cost	Total	Comments
3	Uniforms	25	\$50.00	\$1,250.00	Need to update the team look
4	Baseballs	250	\$4.00	\$1,000.00	We need to 10 per game
5	Umpire fees	25	\$50.00	\$1,250.00	1 Umpire per game
6	Bats	5	\$35.00	\$175.00	We need bats of various sizes
7	Snacks	25	\$15.00	\$375.00	This is the max cost per game for after game snacks
8	Batting helmets	5	\$40.00	\$200.00	We need a minimum of 5
9	Catching Gear	1	\$300.00	\$300.00	Need to protect the catcher, old gear ugly
10	Spare Gloves	4	\$45.00	\$180.00	Just in case someone forgets their glove
11				\$4,730.00	Total
12					

Figure 4: Baseball budget spreadsheet

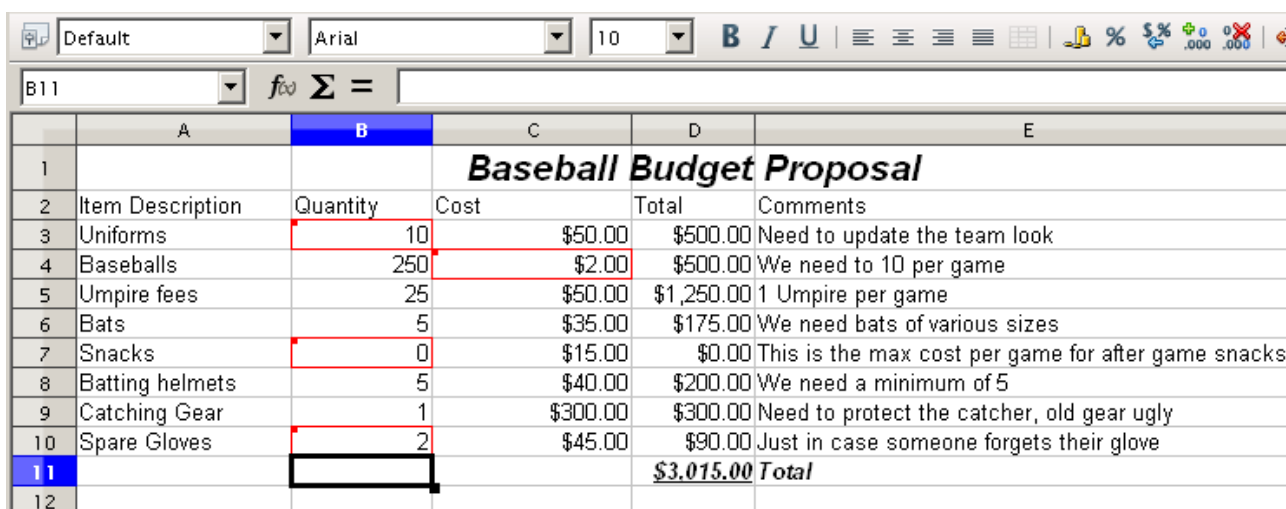
Looking over the figures, you see a few places where money could be saved:

- Parents can buy post-game snacks.
- New uniforms can wait; only buy 10 to replace damaged ones.
- Buy cheaper baseballs.
- Only buy 2 spare gloves.

To make these changes, use the record changes feature in Calc. To start recording changes:

- 1) Open the Budget Spreadsheet.
- 2) Select **Edit > Changes > Record** from the menu bar.
- 3) Begin editing the document.

A colored border, with a dot in the upper left-hand corner, appears around a cell where changes were made. A comment summarizing the change is added to the cell (Figure 5). This way, other reviewers quickly know which cells were edited. A deleted column or row is marked by a heavy-colored bar.



	A	B	C	D	E
1			Baseball Budget Proposal		
2	Item Description	Quantity	Cost	Total	Comments
3	Uniforms	10	\$50.00	\$500.00	Need to update the team look
4	Baseballs	250	\$2.00	\$500.00	We need to 10 per game
5	Umpire fees	25	\$50.00	\$1,250.00	1 Umpire per game
6	Bats	5	\$35.00	\$175.00	We need bats of various sizes
7	Snacks	0	\$15.00	\$0.00	This is the max cost per game for after game snacks
8	Batting helmets	5	\$40.00	\$200.00	We need a minimum of 5
9	Catching Gear	1	\$300.00	\$300.00	Need to protect the catcher, old gear ugly
10	Spare Gloves	2	\$45.00	\$90.00	Just in case someone forgets their glove
11				\$3,015.00	Total
12					

Figure 5: Edited document with red border on changed cells

Tip

Some changes, such as cell formatting, are not recorded and marked.

Tip

To change the color that indicates changes, select **Tools > Options > OpenOffice Calc > Changes**.

When you finish editing the document, you can send it to your coach.

You may want to explain your rationale for changes. You can share your insight by adding comments to the changes you made or adding general comments to the spreadsheet.

Adding Comments to Changes

Calc automatically adds a comment to any recorded change that describes the change (for example, *Cell B4 changed from '9' to '4'*). Reviewers and authors can add their comments to explain their reasons for the changes.

To add a comment to a change:

- 1) Make the change to the spreadsheet.
- 2) Select the cell with the change.
- 3) Choose **Edit > Changes > Comments**. The dialog shown in Figure 6 appears. Calc automatically adds a comment in the title bar of this dialog that cannot be edited.
- 4) Type your comment and click **OK**.

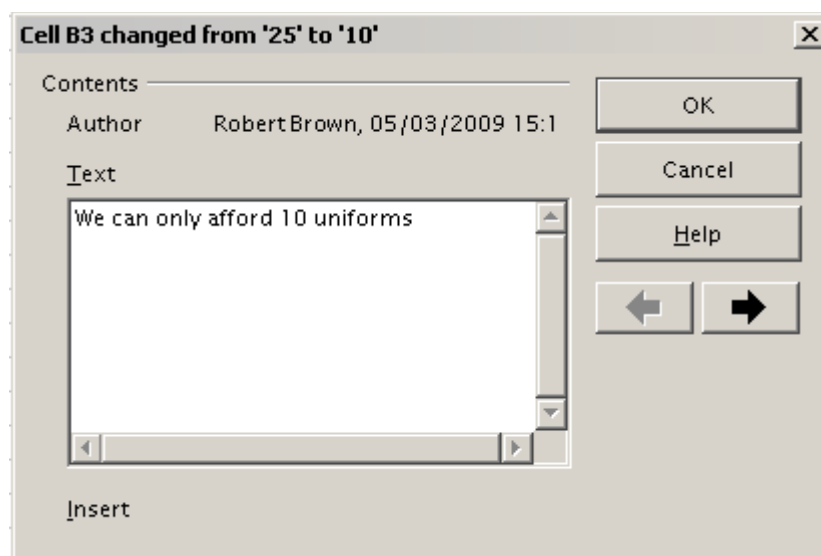


Figure 6: Comment dialog

Tip

You can step through your changes individually using the left and right arrows on the right side of the Comment dialog and add comments to each change. The Comment dialog's title bar shows the cell and the change you are commenting on.

After adding a comment to a changed cell, you can see it by hovering the mouse pointer over the cell, as shown in Figure 7.

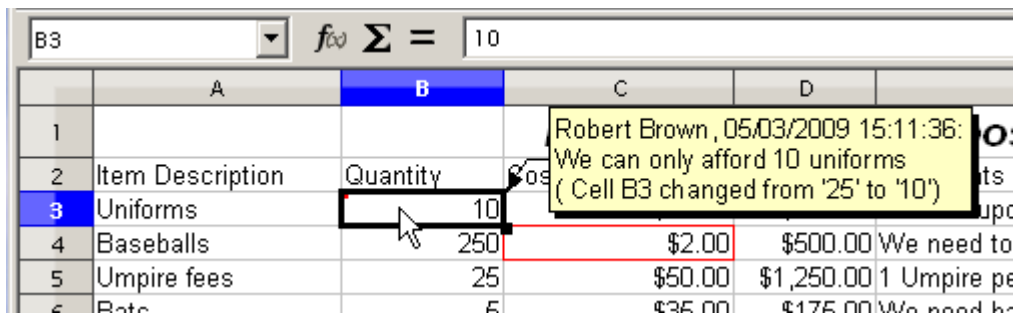


Figure 7: Comment added to cell B3

The comment also appears in the dialog when accepting and rejecting changes, as shown in the first line of Figure 12 on page 12.

Editing Change Comments

- 1) Select the cell with the change comment you want to edit.
- 2) Select **Edit > Changes > Comments**.
- 3) Edit the comment and click **OK**.

Tip

You can view your comments individually using the left and right arrows located on the right side of the Comment dialog. You do not need to click **OK** after editing each comment; you can save them all simultaneously after editing.

Adding Other Comments

Calc provides another type of comment often used by authors and reviewers to exchange ideas, ask for suggestions, or brainstorm in the document.

To add a comment:

- 1) Select the cell to which the comment applies.
- 2) Select **Insert > Comment** or right-click and select **Insert Comment**. (The latter method does not work if the automatic spelling checker is active and the cell contains a misspelled word.) The box shown in Figure 8 appears.
- 3) Type the text of your comment in the box.
- 4) Click outside the box to close it.

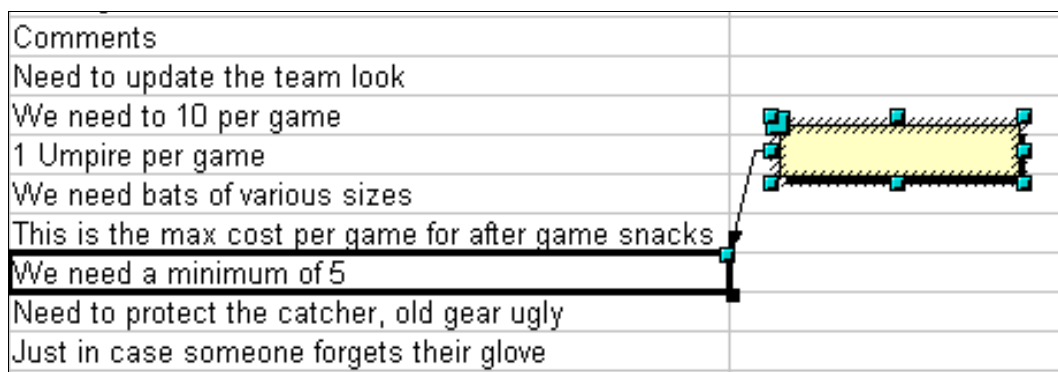


Figure 8: Inserting a comment

The cell you added the comment to now has a colored dot in the upper right corner, as shown in Figure 9. It does not have a colored border unless the cell was also changed.

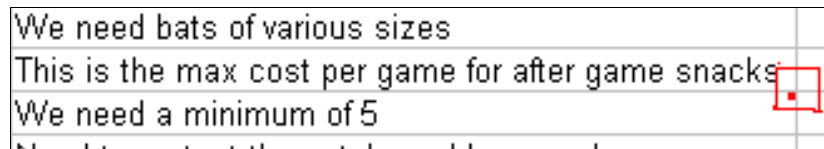


Figure 9: Colored dot in cell containing a comment

Tip

You can change the colors Calc uses for comments by selecting **Tools > Options > OpenOffice > Appearance**.

To view the comment you just added, hover the mouse pointer over the cell with a comment; the comment will appear, as shown in Figure 10.

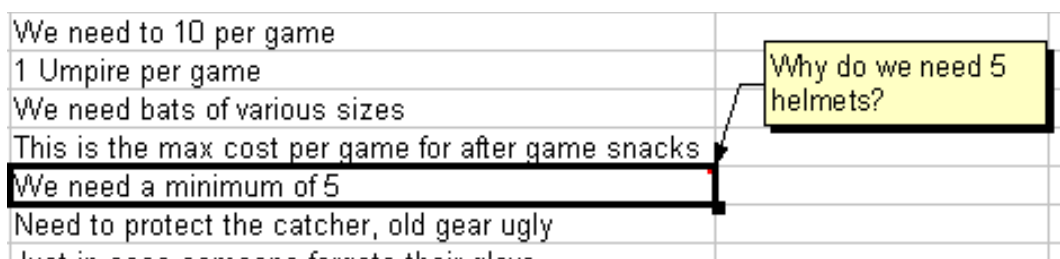


Figure 10: Viewing a comment

Editing Comments

You can edit and format the text of a comment as you do with other text.

- 1) Right-click on the cell containing the comment marker and choose **Show comment** from the pop-up menu.
- 2) Select the comment and double-click it. The cursor changes to the usual blinking text-entry cursor, and the Formatting toolbar changes to show text attributes.
- 3) When done, click outside the comment to deselect it. To hide the comment again, right-click on the cell and deselect **Show Comment** from the pop-up menu.

Formatting Comments

You can change the background color, border style, transparency, and other attributes of a comment.

- 1) Right-click the cell containing the comment marker and choose **Show Comment** from the pop-up menu.
- 2) Click on the comment itself. The Formatting toolbar and the Sidebar Properties pane change to show many comment formatting options. These are the same options for formatting graphics; see Chapter 5 (Using Graphics in Calc) for more information.

You can also right-click on the comment to see a menu of choices, some of which lead to dialogs where you can fine-tune the formatting. These dialogs are also discussed in Chapter 5.

- 3) When done, click outside the comment to deselect it. To hide the comment again, right-click on the cell and deselect **Show Comment** from the pop-up menu.

Finding Comments Using the Navigator

The small comment markers in the corners of cells can be difficult to see. Calc provides another way to find them using the Navigator. If any comments are in the spreadsheet, the Navigator shows a mark (usually a + or an arrow) next to the word Comments. Click on this mark to display a list of comments. Double-click on a comment to jump directly to its associated cell.

Reviewing Changes

At this point, we will change our perspective from the point of view of the team sponsor to that of the coach so we can see how to review and accept or reject the changes to the document the coach originally wrote.

You are the coach of a youth baseball team and you submitted a potential budget created in Calc to your team sponsor.

Your sponsor has reviewed the document using Calc's record changes feature. Now, you want to review those changes and accept or reject the counter proposal.

Because the sponsor recorded changes in Calc, you can easily see what changes were made and decide how to act.

Viewing Changes

Calc gives you tremendous control over what changes you see when reviewing a document. To change the available filters, select **Edit > Changes > Show**. The dialog shown in Figure 11 opens.

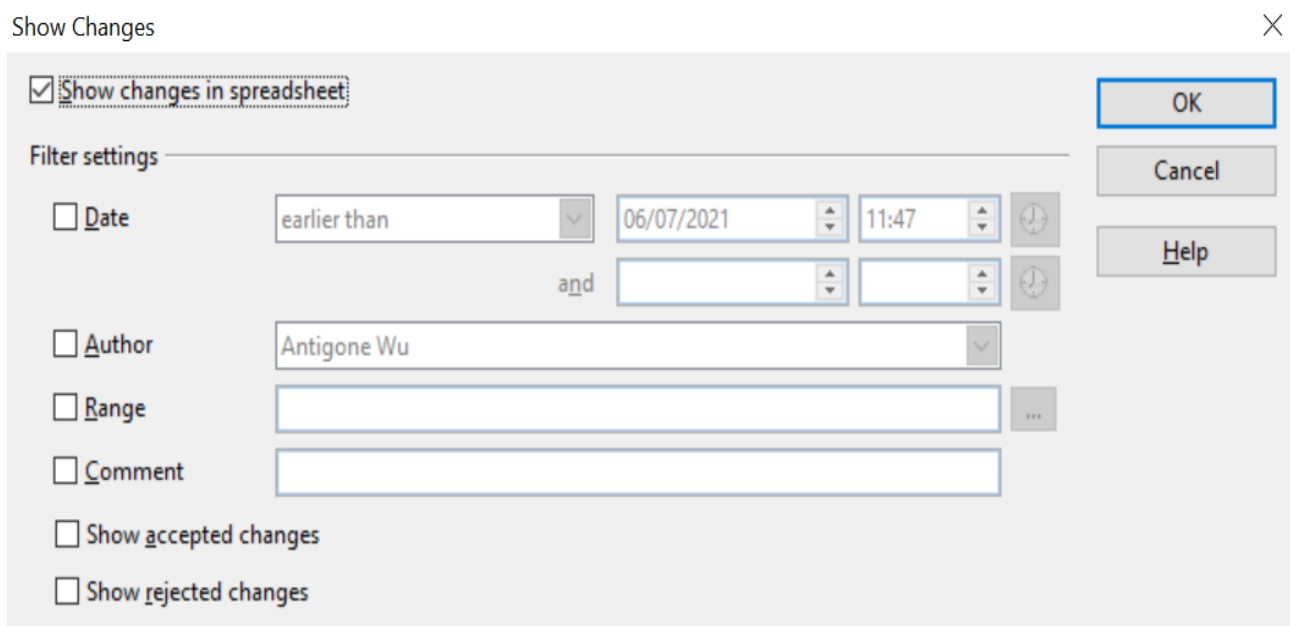


Figure 11: Show changes dialog

You can control which changes appear on the screen using the different settings. You can filter based on:

- Date – Only changes made in a specific time range are displayed.
- Author – Only changes made by a specific author are displayed. This is especially useful if you have multiple reviewers on the document.
- Range – Only changes made in a specific range of cells are displayed. This is especially useful if you have a large spreadsheet and only want to review a part of it.
- Comment – Searches the content of the comments and only displays changes with comments that match the search criteria.
- Show accepted changes – Only changes you accepted are displayed.
- Show rejected changes – Only changes you rejected are displayed.

Note

You can also access the filter control in the Accept or Reject Changes dialog shown in Figure 12. Click the *Filter* tab to view a set of options similar to those shown in Figure 11.

Accepting or Rejecting Changes

When you receive a document back with changes, the beauty of the recording changes system becomes evident. Now, as the original author, you can step through each change and decide how to proceed. To begin this process:

- 1) Open the edited document.
- 2) Select **Edit > Changes > Accept or Reject**. The dialog shown in Figure 12 appears.
- 3) Click Accept or Reject to step through the changes one at a time. You can also choose to accept or reject all changes in one step. Calc creates separate lists of Accepted and Rejected changes. Accepting or Rejecting changes is a non-reversible process. You can undo the changes by comparing the current (edited) document with an earlier version (see page 13).

By default, the *Comment* column contains an explanation of the change that was made. If the reviewer added a comment to the change, it is displayed, followed by the description of the change, as shown in the first line of Figure 12.

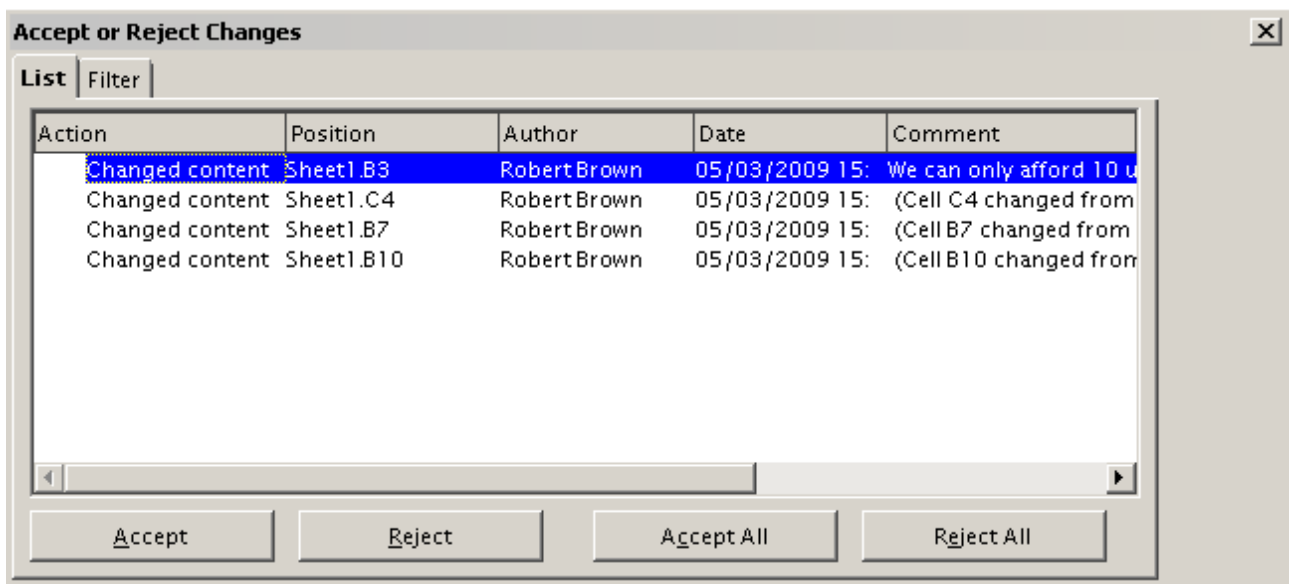


Figure 12: Accept or Reject changes dialog

If multiple people have reviewed the document, one reviewer may have modified another reviewer's change. If so, the changes are hierarchically arranged, with a plus sign to open the hierarchy.

On the Filter tab of this dialog (not shown here), you can choose how to filter the list of changes either by date, author, cell range, or comments containing specific terms. After selecting the filter criteria, switch to the List tab to see the results.

Merging Documents

You submitted your budget proposal to your sponsor and one of your assistant coaches. They both returned their revised budget to you at the same time.

You could review each document and the changes separately, but you want to see both revisions simultaneously to save time.

The processes discussed are effective when you have one reviewer at a time. However, sometimes multiple reviewers all return edited versions of a document simultaneously. In this case, reviewing all of these changes at once may be quicker than one review at a time. For this purpose, you can merge documents in Calc.

To merge documents, all of the edited documents must have recorded changes in them.

- 1) Open the original document.
- 2) Select **Edit > Changes > Merge Document**.
- 3) A file selection dialog opens. Select a file you want to merge and click **OK**.
- 4) After the documents merge, the Accept or Reject Changes dialog opens; see Figure 13, which shows changes by more than one reviewer. If you want to merge more documents, close the dialog and repeat steps 2 and 3.

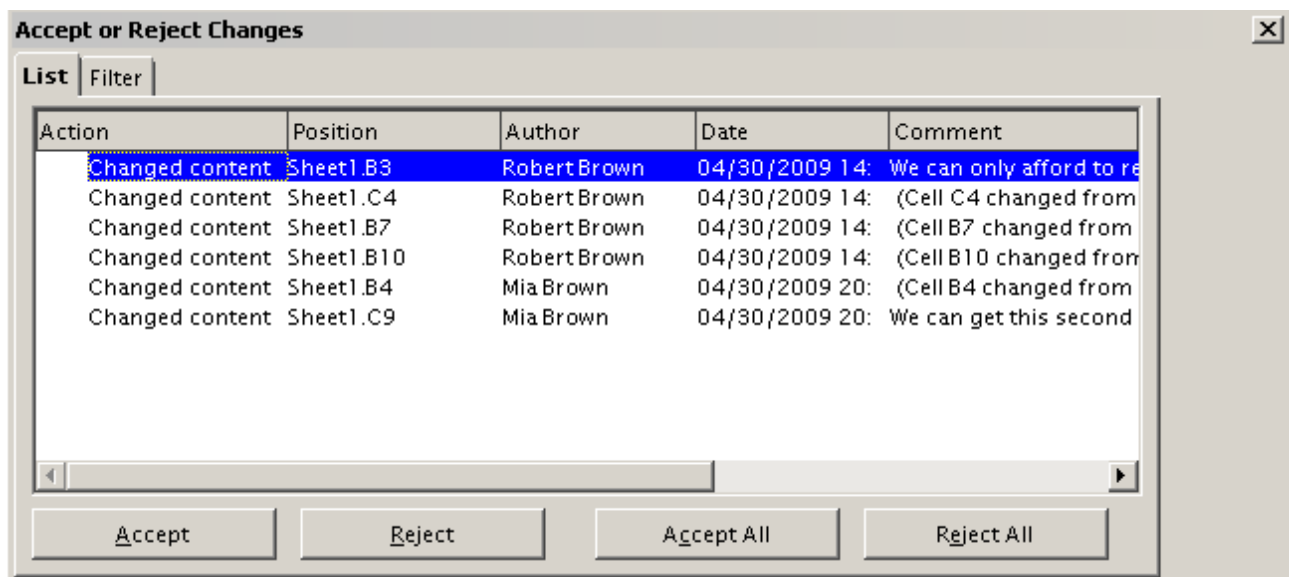


Figure 13: Accept or Reject for merged documents

All changes are now combined into one document; you can accept or reject the changes. Changes from different authors appear in different colors in the document, as shown in Figure 14. In this example, Robert's changes are blue, and Mia's are red.

Baseball Budget Proposal				
Item Description	Quantity	Cost	Total	Comments
Uniforms	10	\$50.00	\$500.00	Need to update the team look
Baseballs	275	\$2.00	\$550.00	We need to 10 per game
Umpire fees	25	\$50.00	\$1,250.00	1 Umpire per game
Bats	5	\$35.00	\$175.00	We need bats of various sizes
Snacks	0	\$15.00	\$0.00	This is the max cost per game for after game snacks
Batting helmets	5	\$40.00	\$200.00	We need a minimum of 5
Catching Gear	1	\$175.00	\$175.00	Need to protect the catcher, old gear ugly
Spare Gloves	2	\$45.00	\$90.00	Just in case someone forgets their glove
			\$2,940.00 Total	

Figure 14: Merged documents with different author colors

Comparing Documents

When sharing documents, reviewers may forget to record their changes. This is not a problem with Calc because it can find the changes by comparing documents.

To compare documents, you need to have the original document and the one that has been edited. To compare them:

- 1) Open the edited document you want to compare with the original document.
- 2) Select **Edit > Compare Document**.
- 3) An open document dialog appears. Select the original document and click **Insert**.

Calc finds and marks the changes as follows:

- Data in the edited document that is not in the original is identified as inserted.
- Data in your original document that is not in the edited document is identified as deleted.

- Data that is changed is marked as changed.

You can now go through and accept or reject changes as you normally would.

Saving Versions

Most documents go through several drafts. Often, it is useful to save new versions of a document. You can do this by saving a copy of the document (under a different name) after each revision or by using Calc's version feature.

Caution



If you do a **Save As...** of a document with different versions stored within it, the old versions are dropped and the new file contains only the latest version.

To use version management in Calc:

- 1) Choose **File > Versions**. The Versions dialog opens as shown below in Figure 15.

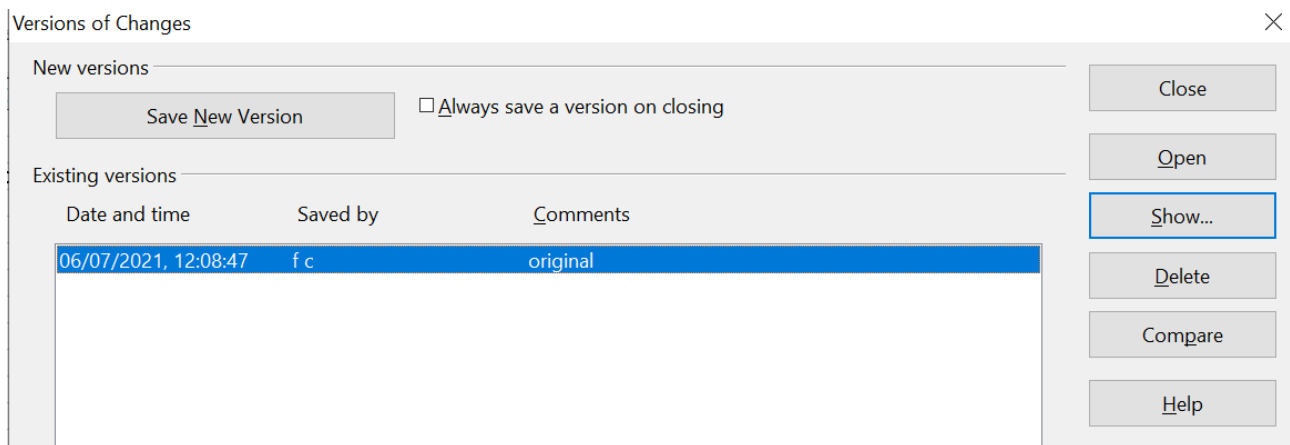


Figure 15: Version management dialog

- 2) Click the **Save New Version** button to save a new version.
- 3) A dialog (Figure 16) opens where you can enter comments about this version.

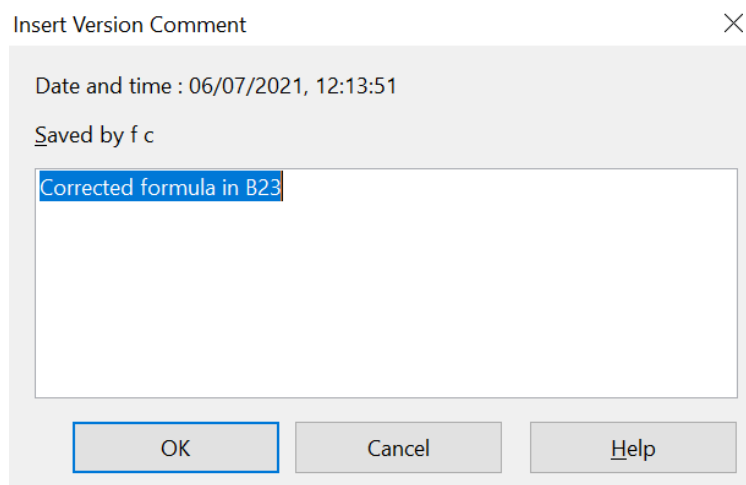


Figure 16: Version comment dialog

- 4) After you enter your comment and click **OK**, the new version appears in the version list, as shown below in Figure 17.

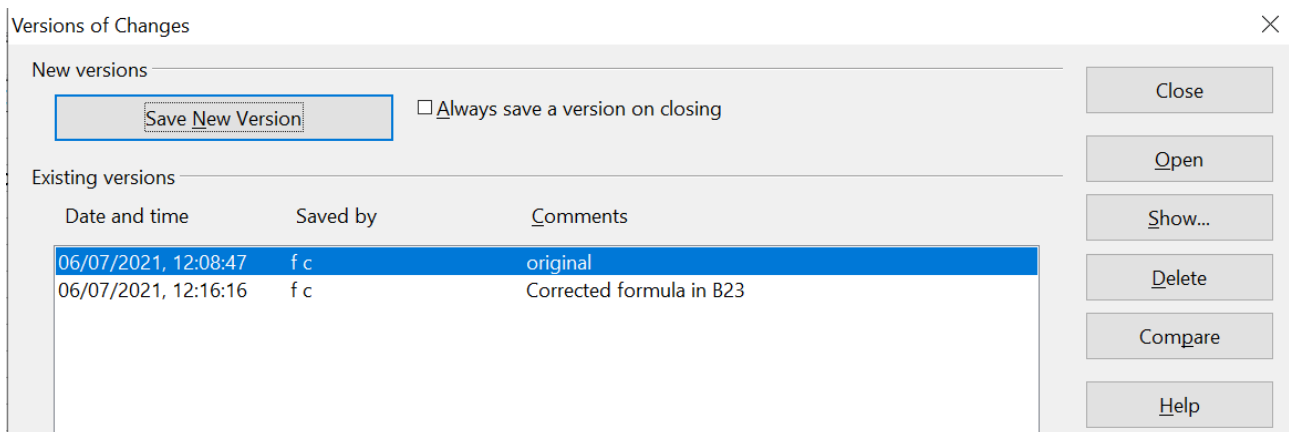


Figure 17: Updated version list

Now, when you save the spreadsheet, both versions are saved in the same physical file. From this point, you can:

- Open an old version – Select the version, click the **Open** button, and a read-only copy of a previous version opens.
- Compare all versions – Clicking the **Compare** button performs an action similar to merging documents. An Accept or Reject Changes dialog opens showing all the changes through the different versions.
- Review the comments – Select a version and click the **Show** button to display the full comments you or other reviewers made.

Note The new file is larger in size, as two spreadsheets are effectively saved together into a single file.
